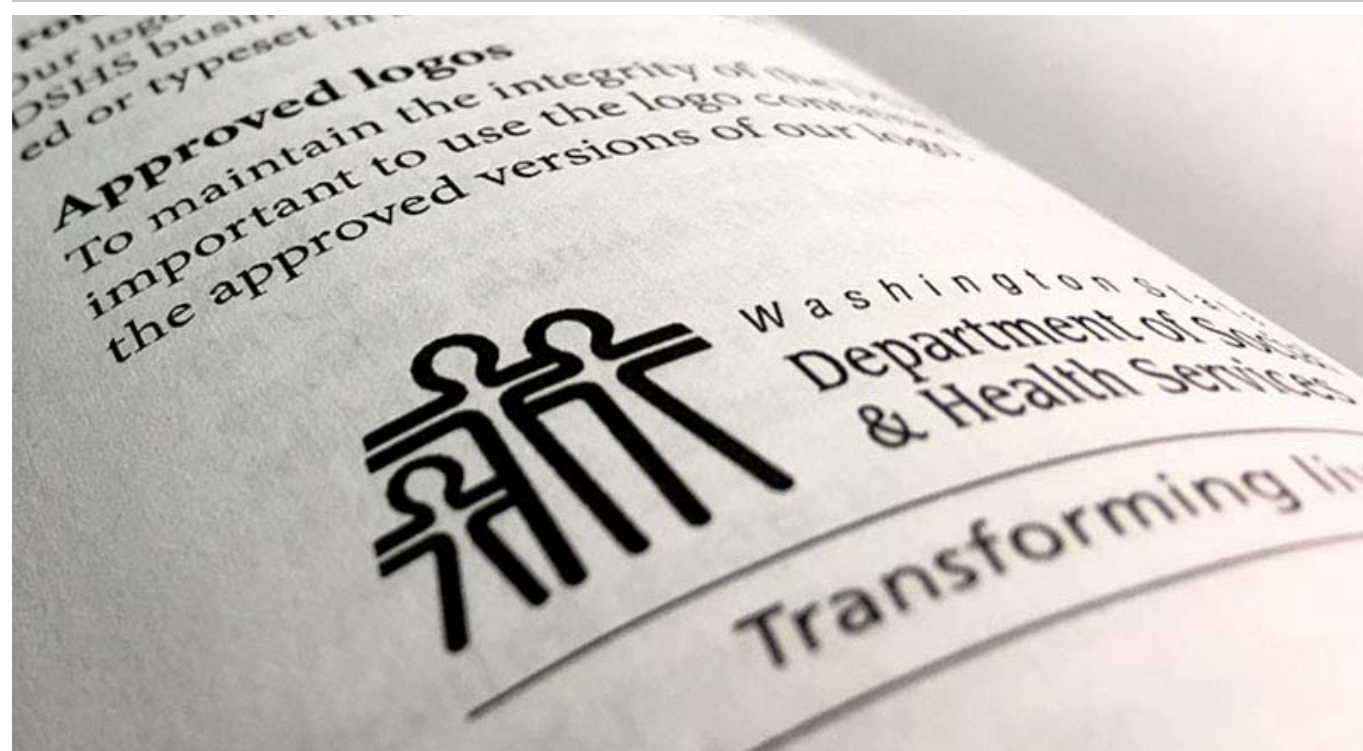


Title Branding: not as painful as it sounds

Body By ESA Communications Manager Chris Britton

UPDATE 5-7-18: *We've been receiving questions about what to do if the fonts on existing DSHS templates don't match the approved fonts described in our branding standards guide (Myriad Pro, Calibri or Calibri Light).*

DSHS Visual Communications has advised us to simply select all the fonts in the template and change them to one of the approved fonts. If you don't have Myriad Pro installed on your machine, then you may use the approved back-up font, Calibri or Calibri Light.



Branding: not as painful as it sounds

By ESA Communications Manager Chris Britton

Branding. It's a term we've all encountered at one time or another during the course of our work. Whether you work for private enterprise or in the public sector, your organization's brand is a critical component of its business.

But what exactly is a brand? Why is it so important?

Internal materials also need to be properly branded.

In this digital age, internal communications can be shared just as readily as external communications, which is why it's just as important to follow the

Most people will tell you an organization's brand is their logo; that's partly accurate, but it represents much more than that.

The brand conveys how that organization or business wants to be perceived, how it relates to its customers, how it conducts business, and why it exists. A brand represents an organization's very *identity*. In order to reinforce that identity, the organization must present that brand consistently.

Consistency conveys credibility

First impressions don't always occur through direct interaction.

A potential customer's first impression may be formed while visiting an organization's website, reading a brochure in a lobby, watching a video on one of its social media sites, or viewing a PowerPoint presentation.

In order for the organization to present the desired perception to the customer, its branding must be consistent across all mediums of communications. This consistency reinforces their identity, avoids confusion in the minds of customers, and builds the perception of credibility, and stability.

Think of your bank. What if one week it changed its logo. Then the next it altered the fonts in the logo. Then the following week they changed the color from blue to orange. Then imagine if their website's branding didn't match your bank statements you received in the mail.

How long would it be before you stopped trusting them with your money?

Remember: *Consistency conveys credibility*.

The same principles apply to DSHS and ESA

As a government department, DSHS must convey stability *and* credibility. This credibility is enhanced in the minds of our public when our materials are branded consistently and correctly. This means using the same colors, the same fonts, the same graphics, and the same logos on all of our materials, including brochures, presentations, posters, websites, etc.

Attempting to manage all of these details can be difficult, at best. Fortunately, branding doesn't have to be as painful as it sounds.

Introducing the DSHS Branding Standards and Style Guide

DSHS Communications has produced a handy reference guide for us to follow, aptly named the [Branding Standards and Style Guide](#). This document provides clear, easy-to-follow guidance on everything from proper logo usage to typography, from agency colors to the correct way to format your email signature (here's a hint: They don't include daisies, Seahawk logos, or dancing cats).

Need something designed? [DSHS Visual Communications](#) is a great resource for all of your graphic design needs. Their dedicated and talented staff are standing by, eager to help you make your project successful—and properly branded.

It's also always a good idea to have your project's text reviewed and approved by your designated communications person, who can ensure it meets the correct AP style standards used in the style guide. If you don't know who your communications lead is for your division, get to know them--You'll find their contact info below this post.

If you have any branding-related questions, [ESA Communications Manager Chris Britton](#) is happy to answer any questions you may have. Please don't hesitate to reach out.

branding used for internal-facing materials. **ESA staff are strongly encouraged to use DSHS-approved templates for their newsletters, fliers, Powerpoint presentations, and other materials.** If you need to some DSHS-approved templates for your next flier, newsletter or Powerpoint presentation, [here's a link to some helpful templates.](#)

Thanks for helping DSHS and ESA maintain a consistent brand!

Find your division's Communications Lead below:

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